



personas of people we meet in real-life, scientific studies have shown. Therefore, having your mugshot is the absolute bare minimum to make your social media profile, well, personable and relatable – apart from your short bio, of course, please don't ignore it as well.

Remember, it's important to not be faceless on social media, but that's not the same as saying you should be obsessed with how you look either. While the former is a courtesy, the latter is a slippery slope that's actually one of the biggest ill-effects of social media, especially with Gen Z and millennials.

FACT CHECK EVERYTHING

Another menace of social media is the explosion of fake news. Experts are calling it an 'infodemic', a deluge of information overload of such unimaginable magnitude that sifting through it to verify if it is fake or not is almost always going to be an



immensely time-consuming effort. Browser extensions like B.S. Detector helps label a piece of information if it originates from its database of fake news websites. Online destinations like FactCheck.org take the help of independent fact checkers to label incorrect information floating around on social media, and WayBack Machine can always let you compare a website or online fact across different snapshots of time.

Next time you want to forward something on your WhatsApp

groups, think if that piece of content is actually true and if it can cause damage by being misinterpreted.

IMAGE > WORDS

The old adage of a picture being worth a thousand words couldn't be more true, especially in a space-

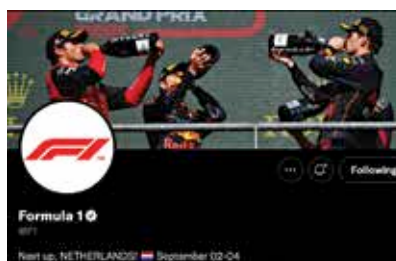


starved social media post going up on Twitter – after all, 280 characters is still too low. Because our brains respond so quickly to images and colour in comparison to other types of information, an image is an almost irresistible way to draw attention to your post on social media. It's crucial to ramp up your social media chops.

Get used to applying impactful image-led posts for conveying deeply meaningful messages, where less is more in every sense of the word. Use websites like Canva.com for templating your image-related social media posts. Instead of text, try making your post into an infographic instead from time to time.

NAME YOUR HANDLE WELL

Part of your social media identity is going to be defined by your online name. It's what most people will associate yourself with when they're trying to think about you,



of course. If you want to be taken seriously by others on social media, then it's imperative you have a non-trivial name.

Choose your real name or something that's associated with your pedigree or personality. A lot of people still like to stay anonymous, which is fine – but that's not the same as choosing a name that's reminiscent of the "screen name" trend of Yahoo Messengers, ICQ and AIM chat apps.

BE HUMAN

Whether your posting on social media on behalf of a company or brand or doing so in your own personal capacity, it's important to remain human in all your online posts and interactions. Treat people with respect, be polite and don't ever post anything that will divide or upset the reader.



Passing the captcha test doesn't make you particularly human. Behave like one.

CONSISTENCY IS KEY

One of the biggest reasons why social media posts don't resonate with the audience is simply down to lack of consistency. It can be as



Gotta pump those Snap blasts out!

simple as consistently posting certain stories during certain times of the day, ensuring consistency of tone and voice especially if it's a serious message. Whether you're posting an image or Infograph, be consistent in your look and feel from every possible aspect to gain user trust and better engagement. **d**